



What used to be seen as optional companions to laptops, tablets are now serious productivity machines, creative canvases, entertainment hubs, and AI-ready devices in their own right. This year's contenders stood out not just for raw performance, but for how thoughtfully they combine design, display technology, ecosystem strength, and real-world usability.

Zero1 Winner: Samsung Galaxy Tab S11 Ultra

Samsung continues its streak of pushing tablets into laptop territory, and the Galaxy Tab S11 Ultra is the clearest example of that ambition. It is incredibly thin, impressively light for its size, and built with a level of polish that few tablets can match. The 14.6-inch Dynamic AMOLED 2X display remains one of the best screens you can find on a portable device, offering superb brightness, rich colours, and smooth 120Hz motion.

The real upgrade this year is the Dimensity 9400+, which delivered chart-topping performance across workloads, be it editing timelines, drawing with the S-Pen, multitasking in DeX Mode, or running intensive AI features introduced with One UI 8 and Android 16. A larger 11,600mAh battery and quad Dolby speakers further cement it as a multimedia powerhouse.

Despite its top-tier performance, it's unapologetically big and best suited to users who can make full use of its display, stylus support, and productivity ecosystem. For those who can, nothing comes close. That's why it's Best Tablet of the Year.

Tablets

Big-screen revival finally!



**Samsung Galaxy
Tab S11 Ultra**
Price: ₹1,24,999



Xiaomi Pad 7
Price: ₹29,999

Runner-up: OnePlus Pad 3

OnePlus has steadily been refining its tablet lineup, and the Pad 3 feels like the moment it fully arrives. The 13.2-inch LTPS LCD panel is vibrant and fluid with its 144Hz refresh rate, while the Snapdragon 8 Elite delivers true flagship-class performance that holds steady even under prolonged workloads. Pair this with a slim 6mm aluminium build and a robust 12,140mAh battery with 80W fast charging, and you have a tablet that feels ready for productivity and entertainment in equal measure.

What makes the Pad 3 stand out is its software. OxygenOS 15's multitasking features, particularly Open Canvas, are among the most seamless implementations on an Android tablet. The O+ Connect feature, despite being occasionally inconsistent, adds a unique ability to remotely control Windows and macOS machines, expanding its utility for hybrid workers.

It doesn't quite dethrone Samsung, but it's one of the strongest Android tablets of the year.



OnePlus Pad 3
Price: ₹49,999

Best Buy: Xiaomi Pad 7

The Xiaomi Pad 7's 11.2-inch 3:2 display is excellent for productivity and shows impressive brightness numbers in technical testing. Xiaomi's nano-texture variant, designed to cut reflections without compromising sharpness, is a standout feature in this price segment.

The Pad 7 delivered smooth performance across productivity apps, casual gaming, and heavy multitasking, showing numbers that far exceed what its price would suggest. HyperOS 2 adds features like floating windows and workstation mode. For its balance of performance, display quality, thoughtful features, and aggressive pricing, it earns our Best Buy Award.

— Siddharth Chauhan | editor@digit.in